

Data Analysis

DOA form

Luis Carlos Guevara
Faculty of Finance,
Government and International Relations

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Design of Analysis form	
Academic Year: 2026 I	Names:
Provisional project title:	

1. Project context & problematization

In this section you should establish the "Why" of the research before diving into the "How."

Research context & problem statement

Briefly describe the context and the specific justiciable problem. Why is this a problem now? Use reliable data and references to support your statements. Narrow the scope of your problematization by describing explicitly: time frames, geographical frames and demographic groups of interest.

- What is the general topic?
- What is the specific background?
- What is the specific "pain point" or gap you are investigating?

2. Questions and hypothesis

In this section you should establish the "What" of the research before diving into the "How."

Research question

What is the one main question this project answers? Bear in mind how this question stems for your problematization.

Research questions

Mixed methods require different types of questions. Please separate them:

- Quantitative Question (The "What/How much")
- Qualitative Question (The "Why/How")

Research hypothesis

What is your predicted answer to the quantitative question based on theory? Present the hypothesis using a formal structure, that is, a null and an alternative statement that directly connects with your quantitative research question. Ensure your hypothesis variables match the Dependent and Independent variables you list in the Measurement section.

Research objectives

Define the single, overarching goal of the project. Focus on the final outcome. Use comprehensive verbs like "analyse," "evaluate," or "determine." avoid "yes/no" goals.

Specific Objectives

Break the general goal into measurable steps. Align these with your mixed methods.

3. Philosophical assumptions

In this section you should describe how your world view interacts and shapes your research.

Theoretical purpose

Present how answering the questions you've proposed can contribute to the broader theoretical and knowledge body of work in your problem area.

Practical purpose and impact

Present how answering the questions you've proposed can impact the realities of the populations it focuses on.

World view and Interest

Present why are you are interested in addressing the problem you have described, also how your points of view and philosophies shape that interest.

4. Research design & strategy

In this section you should describe how you plan to develop your research, and the frameworks that will host the methodological approaches you'll develop to carry out your study.

Mixed methods design type

Select one: Convergent Parallel, Explanatory Sequential, Exploratory Sequential, or Embedded. Justify your selection based on answering your research question and facing the identified research problem. Also present why is one method insufficient?

5. Research methodology

In this section you should describe "How" you intend to research your proposed topic, identifying relevant methods that will enable you to achieve your research objective(s).

Sampling Strategy

Present details on:

- **The overall population:** who is the general population of interest?
- **Quantitative Sample Specifics**
 - Data Source: primary or secondary data collection
 - Sample selection method
 - Disaggregation/unit of analysis and time
 - Sample size
- **Qualitative Sample Specifics**
 - Data Source: e.g. interviews, focus groups, text analysis
 - Selection method
 - Disaggregation/unit of analysis and time
 - Sample size

Measurement & Variables

Present details on:

- **Quantitative Variables**
 - Dependent variable(s): define the outcome variable and its nature
 - Independent variables
 - Moderation and/ or mediation variables
- **Qualitative Concepts/Variables**
 - What central phenomena you will be exploring?

Analysis Plans

Present details on:

- **Quantitative analysis plan**
 - Model type: specify the technique/model you will be using. Justify its selection. (e.g., Binary Logistic Regression, Ordinal Logit, OLS, Multilevel/Hierarchical Model).
 - Model structure/equation: write the formal equation or functional form.
 - Robustness checks: how will you validate results?
- **Qualitative analysis plan**
 - Analytic approach: thematic analysis, grounded theory, content analysis?
 - Coding strategy: deductive (theory-driven) or inductive (data-driven)?

Data integration

Present details on:

- **The point of Integration:** when do the methods mix? (e.g., During interpretation, or using Quant results to select Qual interviewees).
- **Integration Strategy:** how will you combine them? (e.g., "Triangulation" to see if results agree, or "Expansion" to use Qual to explain Quant outliers).

6. Ethics & Timeline and planning

Ethical Considerations

Address consent, anonymity, and data protection for both strands. (e.g., anonymization of survey data). Please specify under which proprietary and confidentiality conditions you are allowed to use the existing data. Please specify whether the research involves any form of deception, which research ethics guidelines you have consulted, and which safeguards you intend to undertake to protect subjects' dignity, anonymity, and confidentiality.

Timeline

Present a detailed description of the activities of your project using a Gantt chart or a list of phases.

Anticipated problems

Please identify any potential problems you might encounter in undertaking your research and describe how you plan to overcome these.

Sections/chapter headings

Please outline the intended structure of the dissertation, including brief details of the contents of the respective sections/chapters.

7. References

References

Please provide details of literature relevant to your proposed research.